

KIARASH KIANI FERIZ

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EDUCATION

Sharif University of Technology

B.S. Computer Engineering

September 2022 – April 2027

Current GPA: 19.21/20.00

RESEARCH INTEREST

- ML Privacy and Security
- Large Language Models
- Computer Vision

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant (Ehsaneddin Asgari)

July 2024 – Present

- Co-authored a comprehensive survey paper on generative AI for character animation, covering face generation, expression rendering, gesture and motion synthesis, avatar creation, and texture modeling.
- Explored and explained the latest advances in diffusion and foundation models, helping readers understand key trends, real-world uses, and how these systems are evaluated.
- *Paper:* Generative AI for Character Animation: A Comprehensive Survey of Techniques, Applications, and Future Directions

Research Assistant (Mohammad Hossein Rohban)

February 2025 – Present

- Co-authored a paper on logical anomaly detection for industrial images, achieving competitive results with state-of-the-art methods.
- *Paper:* CELAD: Compositional Evaluation for Logical Anomaly Detection
- Developed **GhostWord**, a word-level, temporally localized data-poisoning backdoor attack on Automatic Speech Recognition (ASR) systems that uses acoustic triggers for precise semantic and sentence-level manipulation.
- *Paper:* GhostWord: A Fine-Grained Backdoor Attack on Automatic Speech Recognition (Accepted at TMLR)
- Proposed **TransferBreaker**, a unified fine-tuning framework to mitigate adversarial transferability in black-box ASR deployments.
- *Paper:* Breaking Adversarial Transferability in Fine-Tuned Speech Recognition (Accepted at NeurIPS 2026)
- Collaborated with Prof. Mohammad Sabokrou on improving the adversarial robustness of speech foundation models through hierarchical stabilization.
- *Paper:* Transferable Adversarial Robustness for Speech Foundation Models via Hierarchical Stabilization (under review at ICASSP 2027)
- Investigated how adversarial robustness can be transferred to specialized descendants of speech foundation models, developing methods to preserve robustness during downstream specialization.
- *Paper:* Robustness After Specialization: Installing Adversarial Robustness in Speech Foundation Model Descendants (under review at ICLR 2027)

VOLUNTEERING

Sharif University of Technology

Teaching Assistance

- Probability and Statistic
- Linear Algebra
- Artificial Intelligence
- Machine Learning

HONORS AND AWARDS

National University Entrance Exam (Konkur)

2022

- **Ranked 23th** among more than 150,000 participants (top 0.02%)